



Cricket commentary on Alexa

Amazon's Assistant, Alexa will now give you live cricket scores, commentary, and more from now on. <https://digit.in/nov22-37>



iCloud on the web

Apple has released the beta iCloud web client, making it more customisable for users. <https://digit.in/nov22-38>

Lenovo IdeaPad Gaming 3i

Bang For Your Buck

Competition in the budget gaming laptop market is fierce. The IdeaPad Gaming

laptops are Lenovo's budget alternative to their more premium Legion lineup of gaming laptops, and as such, sacrifices have been made to reduce costs. However, what we have on offer here with the Lenovo IdeaPad Gaming 3i still makes it quite an enticing option for anyone in the market looking for a gaming laptop under the Rs 1 lakh budget.

BUILD AND DESIGN

While the overall aesthetic of the IdeaPad Gaming 3i remains the same as its predecessors, there are some pretty major changes. For starters, they've extended the back. This has allowed them to not only have two vents on the back, but also move most of the IO ports. The new hinge however feels pretty flimsy. The laptop body is made entirely out of plastic as opposed to metal like the Legion laptops. But then again, that is to be expected from the budget segment. The IdeaPad Gaming laptops come with nice full-sized keyboards, with the arrow keys slightly separated from the rest of the keyboard. Overall with the backlight added, probably one of the best keyboards you can get in the budget gaming laptop segment. The trackpad is also not very large and slightly off-centre, so it doesn't get in the way while typing. Under the laptop, you've got the ventilation grill and the two speaker cutouts on either side.

I/O

Next we come to the ports. You've got a gen 1 USB Type-A 3.2 port on either side of the laptop. On the left, you've got a combo audio jack. The rest of the



I/O has been moved to the back, where there's an HDMI 2.0 port, an ethernet port, a Thunderbolt 4 port and power.

DISPLAY

For the display, the unit we received came with a 15.6-inch FHD 120 Hz IPS panel. 120Hz is nice, but there is a FHD 165Hz option and a 16-inch WQHD 165Hz display option as well. During our display benchmarks, we got an average brightness of 337 nits, which is not bad. As for sRGB, the display scored pretty high with 98.9 per cent sRGB coverage. Even the DCI-P3 coverage was 75.4 per cent which is pretty good as far as a budget gaming laptop is concerned.

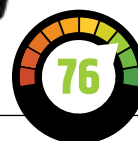
PERFORMANCE

The unit we received came with the Intel Core i7-12700H and NVIDIA RTX 3050Ti combo. It actually scored slightly higher than the Alienware X14 which comes with the exact same configuration as far as the processor and GPU are considered, in just about every processor and gaming benchmark, save a few. Considering the price difference, the Gaming 3i is essentially selling itself right now. In 3DMark, the X14 scores better in both TimeSpy benchmarks, while the 3i scores higher in all FireStrike benchmarks. The overall scores are still very close. The laptop scores higher in

just about all of our gaming benchmark results, save Valorant. Even if by a few FPS, it's outperforming a laptop that's almost twice its price. Impressive.

MEMORY AND STORAGE

The laptop we received came with 16 GB of DDR4 3200MHz RAM. We tested the RAM using AIDA64, the results are pretty good. Coming to the storage, the laptop came with a Gen 4 1TB PCIe NVMe TLC M.2 2242 SSD. The read and write speeds are decent and close to advertised speeds.



FEATURES & SPEC.....75
PERFORMANCE.....83
VALUE FOR MONEY ...73
DESIGN73

HEAT AND NOISE

For most of our testing the laptop ran pretty cool. So their cooling solution works. Surface level temps never crossed 45 degrees, and the palm area stayed cool for the most part.

Like with most gaming

laptops it will get loud as you do more intensive stuff.

VERDICT

Lenovo has certainly taken a step up with the new IdeaPad Gaming 3i. As far as value for money is concerned, you're definitely getting bang for your buck here. While it's a great pick in the sub 1 lakh budget gaming laptop category, you also have the likes of the Acer Nitro 5 which comes very close in terms of performance and in some cases performs better. All that said, this is still a solid pick if you're in the market for an entry level gaming laptop that can handle most modern AAA games.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

DISPLAY: 39.62cms (15.6) FHD (1920 x 1080), IPS, Anti-Glare, Non-Touch, 45% NTSC, 250 Nits, 120Hz | PROCESSOR: 12th Generation Intel® Core™ i7-12700H Processor | GRAPHICS: Nvidia RTX 3050 Ti | MEMORY: 16GB LPDDR5, 5200 MHz | STORAGE: 1TB NVMe SSD | PORTS: 2xUSB 3.2 Gen 1, HDMI 2.0, Ethernet (RJ-45), Headphone / microphone combo jack (3.5mm) | CONNECTIVITY: 11AX (2x2) & Bluetooth® 5.1 | BATTERY: 60 Whr | DIMENSIONS: 359.6 x 266.4 x 21.8 mm | WEIGHT: 2.3kg

CONTACT

PHONE: 1800-419-7555 | EMAIL: NA | WEBSITE: www.lenovo.com/in/en